

World Religions 30
Assignment Booklet #1
Chapter 1: The Religious Impulse

Name: _____

Part One: Multiple-Choice Items

Read each item carefully and decide which choice best completes the statement or answers the question. Type the letter of your choice in the blank space before the item. (20 marks).

_____	1. Religious pluralism refers to A. the practice of changing religions each year B. a positive attitude toward the existence of many faiths in one society C. the idea that only one religion deserves respect D. the separation of religion from ethics
_____	2. According to Chapter 1, the one common thread through countless diversities of human religion has been the instinct or impulse to A. worship something B. avoid all suffering C. reject community life D. create political parties
_____	3. Which of the following is NOT listed as a common feature of religion? A. organized institutions B. sacred writings or scriptures C. rules of conduct D. stock market regulation
_____	4. In the chapter, ethnicity refers primarily to a person's A. rituals and practices B. origins, race, or culture C. theology D. salvation
_____	5. The chapter suggests that popular culture is often A. a perfect substitute for genuine understanding B. a poor substitute for genuine understanding C. unrelated to religion D. more reliable than study
_____	6. A person who holds that no god exists is called an A. agnostic B. atheist C. theologian D. ritualist
_____	Please use the following information to answer question 7. Even in the Technological Age, people still ask questions such as "Who am I?" and "Why am I here?"

	7. This idea best supports the view that A. technology has replaced religion B. human beings still search for meaning beyond material progress C. science makes ethics unnecessary D. religion belongs only to the distant past
_____	8. One reason people turn to religion, according to the chapter, is A. guaranteed material wealth B. a search for answers to life's big questions C. proof that all suffering will end D. freedom from every difficult choice
_____	9. Lewis Browne stated that every great religion includes at least three aspects: faith, hope, and A. law B. charity C. reason D. nationality
_____	10. Which term refers to a prescribed religious procedure or performance? A. symbol B. ritual C. credo D. secularism
_____	11. In the twenty-first century, science and religion may best be described as A. permanently hostile rivals B. identical in every way C. mutually supportive and complementary in some areas D. unrelated to questions of truth
_____	12. Which of the following is the best example of a primary source? A. an article on the history of Hinduism B. a documentary on the Prophet Muhammad C. a diary belonging to the Dalai Lama D. a textbook chapter about Buddhism
_____	13. Bias is best described as A. a fully balanced presentation of evidence B. a fixed opinion formed without fair examination of facts C. a list of neutral statistics D. a type of sacred writing
_____	14. A credo is A. a statement of belief or philosophy B. a religious holiday

	C. a place of worship D. a form of government
_____	15. In Canada, religion and the State are described in the chapter as A. fully merged institutions B. separate institutions C. controlled by provinces only D. under the authority of one faith tradition
_____	16. Chapter 1 uses Christmas mainly to illustrate that A. sacred and secular elements can become mixed in one celebration B. Santa Claus is central to Christian theology C. only Christians celebrate December holidays D. the exact birth date of Jesus is known with certainty
_____	17. An agnostic is a person who A. believes many gods exist B. doubts that humans can know whether God exists C. studies theology professionally D. rejects moral rules
_____	18. Which example best shows religious pluralism in Canada? A. people of many faiths living together in relative harmony B. only one religion being recognized in society C. assuming ethnicity determines religion D. replacing all religious discussion with advertising
_____	19. A source using emotional language, screaming titles, and sweeping generalizations should be treated as A. automatically trustworthy B. probably biased C. purely factual D. a primary source
_____	20. According to the chapter, one group identified as more likely to attend religious services regularly was A. recent immigrants B. television producers C. tourists D. all teenagers equally

Part Two: Matching

Choose the letter of the term that best describes the concept or completes the sentence. Terms may be used more than once, and not all terms will be used. Enter the letter of the term into the blank space beside each statement. (15 marks).

Answer	Statement	Terms
_____	1. A person who doubts humankind can know the existence of a possible god.	A. agnostic B. atheist C. bias D. credo E. ethics F. ethnicity G. humanist H. multi-faith I. primary source J. religious impulse K. religious pluralism L. ritual M. sacred N. secular O. secondary source P. soul Q. symbol R. theology
_____	2. One who holds that no god exists.	
_____	3. A fixed opinion formed without fair examination of facts.	
_____	4. A philosophy or a set of beliefs.	
_____	5. A system of morals or rules for human conduct.	
_____	6. A person's origins, race, or culture rather than his or her religion.	
_____	7. Firsthand evidence such as a diary, interview, or photograph.	
_____	8. The universal urge to believe in something beyond ourselves.	
_____	9. A positive attitude toward the existence of many faiths in one society.	
_____	10. A prescribed religious procedure or performance.	
_____	11. Connected with religion.	
_____	12. Concerned with or belonging to the material world.	
_____	13. A second-hand account based on primary sources.	
_____	14. The spiritual or immaterial part of a human being.	
_____	15. A mark or object that represents an idea, process, or function.	

Part Three: True or False

Read each statement carefully and decide if it is true or false. Type T or F in each blank beside the statement to indicate your choice for each. (15 marks).

_____	1. Chapter 1 suggests that all religions can be reduced to one exact definition that everyone accepts.
_____	2. Belief and practice are better indicators of a person's religion than ethnicity.
_____	3. Popular culture always gives an accurate picture of religion.
_____	4. The chapter describes Christmas as containing both sacred and secular elements.
_____	5. Santa Claus has a direct connection to the birth of Jesus Christ.
_____	6. Science and religion are presented only as enemies with no shared concerns.
_____	7. A primary source includes firsthand evidence such as an interview or diary.
_____	8. Arguments are based on facts and try to explain an event or draw a conclusion.
_____	9. Canadians are free to observe any religion or no religion at all.
_____	10. The Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms includes freedom of conscience and religion.
_____	11. The exact date of Christ's birth is known with certainty.
_____	12. The chapter suggests that technology has answered every major human question.
_____	13. Regular attendance at religious services increased sharply between 1988 and 1998.
_____	14. The authors say world religions should be studied comparatively, not competitively.
_____	15. Religious pluralism is presented as a defining feature of Canadian life.

Part Four: Written-Response Items

Respond to the following items on the lines below the items. Attach additional pages if you need more space. (62 marks).

1. In your own words, define religion. Include at least two common elements that appear in the chapter's definitions of religion. (4 marks)

2. Explain the phrase religious impulse. (2 marks)

3. Describe four reasons people turn to religion according to Chapter 1. (4 marks)

4. What is the difference between religion and ethics? (3 marks)

5. Explain how science and religion can coexist, according to the chapter. (4 marks)

6. Distinguish between a primary source and a secondary source. Give one example of each related to the study of world religions. (4 marks)

7. What is bias? Give two signs that a source may be biased. (3 marks)

8. Explain the difference among fact, opinion, and argument. Then provide one original example of each related to religion or culture. (6 marks)

9. Why may ethnicity not be a reliable indicator of a person's religion? (3 marks)

10. The chapter suggests that popular culture can shape people's views of religion. Explain one benefit and one danger of learning about religion mainly through popular culture. (4 marks)

11. Compare the sacred and secular aspects of Christmas discussed in the chapter. Give at least two examples of each. (4 marks)

12. Why might some Christians and some non-Christians both have concerns about the way Christmas is celebrated in Canada? (4 marks)

13. How is religious freedom protected in Canada? Refer to at least two specific rights mentioned in the chapter. (4 marks)

14. Briefly explain the difference among an atheist, an agnostic, and a humanist. (3 marks)

15. The chapter notes that married couples with children, senior citizens, recent immigrants, and rural Canadians were more likely to attend religious services regularly. Select any three of these groups and suggest one possible reason each might show higher attendance. (6 marks)

16. Why do the authors say their approach to world religions is comparative, not competitive? (4 marks)

Part Five: Student-Choice

Select either Option A or Option B and complete the associated tasks. Use reliable sources and attach additional pages if you need more room. (16 marks).

Option A: Religion in Popular Culture

Using one song, film, television episode, online video, or another media text with religious themes, respond to the following items as you conduct your analysis:

1. Identify the media text you selected (song, film, television episode, online video, etc.), the creator, and where you found it. (2 marks)

2. Briefly summarize how religion, spirituality, or a religious group is represented in the media text. (4 marks)

3. Explain whether the representation is respectful, stereotypical, accurate, sensationalized, or mixed. Give at least two specific examples from the media text. (4 marks)

4. Describe how this representation could shape a Canadian viewer's understanding of religion or religious people. (3 marks)

5. Provide a bibliography of at least two sources using proper format. (3 marks)

Option B: Religious Pluralism in Canada

Using reliable sources, research one Canadian example of interfaith or multi-faith practice. Then respond to the following items as you conduct your research:

1. Describe one Canadian example of interfaith or multi-faith practice in sufficient detail (for example: a festival, school event, community organization, public ceremony, or multicultural calendar project). (4 marks)

2. Identify the religious or cultural traditions involved in your example. (2 marks)

3. Explain how your example shows both benefits and challenges of religious pluralism. (4 marks)

4. Connect your example to two ideas from Chapter 1 (such as religious freedom, dialogue, religion and the state, popular culture, or multi-faith families). (3 marks)

5. Provide a bibliography of at least two sources using proper format. (3 marks)

End of Assignment Booklet 1

After you have completed all items, submit your work according to your course instructions.